TIMELINE

- **Day before:** Feed the stiff levain (1:5:2.5); ripe in 8-12 hrs.
- **Mix:** Develop gluten fully, then add butter in 4-5 additions; DDT 74-76°F (23-24°C). Hold back ~15 g of liquid (orange juice) as bassinage.
- **Bulk:** Bank a 30-40% room-temp rise (2-3 hrs), then cold retard 12-16 hrs.
- **Filling puck:** Mix tahini-cocoa paste, press to a ~6.5 in disk between parchment, freeze 30 min (or fridge overnight).
- **Shape:** Reserve 130 g for bones; roll the rest to ~11 in, set the puck dead center, pleat 8-10 times over it, pinch the seam, flip seam-down.
- **Final proof:** 3-4 hrs at room temp, until puffy with a slow, partial spring-back.
- **Bones & skull:** Size bones with string over the proofed dome; glue with egg white; wash lightly.
- **Bake:** 350°F (177°C), 50-60 min; tent with foil at ~20 min; crumb 190-195°F about 1.5 in from center.
- **Finish & cool:** Two thin coats of melted butter within 5 min of the oven, fine orange sugar, sesame. Rest 45-60 min before slicing.

NOTES

◆ FOLD ALONG THIS LINE, TOP PANEL BACK — STANDS LIKE A TENT ◆

Bone Appétit

A sourdough pan de muerto with a tahini-cocoa heart -- Well Bread's brioche base, orange-scented, for Día de Muertos and Halloween

DOUGH INGREDIENTS

Bread flour	450 g	100%
Stiff starter (45-50% hydration, ripe)	180 g	40%
Whole milk, cold	100 g	22%
Fresh orange juice, cold	40 g	9%
Whole eggs (3 large), cold	150 g	33%
Egg yolks (2 large), cold	36 g	8%
Granulated sugar	75 g	17%
Fine sea salt	9 g	2%
Unsalted butter, softened	160 g	36%
Instant yeast (optional insurance)	3 g	0.7%
Zest of 2 oranges + orange emulsion 1 tsp	~13 g	
Total dough weight	**~1,216 g**	

INCLUSIONS

Tahini-cocoa filling: tahini 100 g, Majestic cocoa 45 g, powdered sugar 60 g, soft butter 20 g, juice, emulsion, cinnamon, salt (pressed to a ~6.5 in puck)	**~250 g**

One loaf, ~1,470 g, about 16 slices. Hold back 130 g of dough for bones and skull (shaped after proof). Finish: 30 g melted butter, 60 g fine sugar + 1 orange zest, 2 tbsp sesame.

NOTES